WEEK 10 · LECTURE L2 · UNIT IV

Integrating Learning and Development with Performance

Transfer of training, the 70:20:10 claim, deliberate practice and its limits, spacing, and competency models.

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AFTER THIS LECTURE YOU SHOULD BE ABLE TO

What this lecture prepares you for

- Explain the inputs that decide whether training transfers to work.
- Evaluate the evidence for the 70:20:10 ratio.
- Evaluate how much deliberate practice explains across domains.
- Apply spacing and competency modeling to a development roadmap.

COURSE OUTCOMES

CLO 5 (create talent development programs) and CLO 1 (design integrated systems).

COMMIT BEFORE THEORY

Seventy percent of learning at work happens on the job.

Where does this figure come from? Is it a finding?

THEORY IN DEPTH · BALDWIN AND FORD (1988); BLUME ET AL. (2010)

Why training fails to transfer

THE CORE IDEA

Transfer depends on the trainee, the design of training, and the work environment afterwards.

HOW IT WORKS

Ability, motivation, supportive supervisors and the chance to use the skill all related to transfer.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Transfer is hard to measure, and many studies rely on self reports.

IN PRACTICE

A coaching course for supervisors fails because their own managers never ask them to coach.

EXAM LENS

Use the three inputs to diagnose any failed training. The work environment is the most neglected.

THE 70:20:10 CLAIM

A ratio in search of evidence

ORIGIN · MCCALL, LOMBARDO AND MORRISON (1988)

Drawn from interviews with successful executives about the events that developed them.

STATUS · CLARDY (2018)

The ratio itself has not been established by research: a heuristic, not a law.

EXAM LENS

Treat 70:20:10 as a reminder that most learning happens through work, not as a budget rule.

THEORY IN DEPTH · ERICSSON ET AL. (1993); MACNAMARA ET AL. (2014)

Deliberate practice and its limits

THE CORE IDEA

Expert performance develops through effortful practice designed to improve, with feedback.

HOW IT WORKS

Macnamara et al. found practice explained 26 percent of performance variance in games, 21 in music, 18 in sports, 4 in education and under 1 in professions.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Practice matters, but far less in professional work than the original theory suggested.

IN PRACTICE

A sales academy adds structured role plays with feedback; gains are real but smaller than hoped.

EXAM LENS

Use both sources together: deliberate practice helps, but in professions most variance lies elsewhere.

Spacing and competencies

SPACING · CEPEDA ET AL. (2006)

Learning spread over time is retained far better than the same learning massed together.

COMPETENCY MODELS · CAMPION ET AL. (2011)

Useful when tied to strategy, built from job data and used consistently across HR.

COMPARE AND EVALUATE

Three ways to build capability

Approach	Strength	Weakness
Formal training	Structured and scalable	Often fails to transfer
Learning on the job	Real tasks and context	Uneven and hard to measure
Deliberate practice	Targeted improvement with feedback	Explains little in professions

EXAM LENS

A capability roadmap combines all three, spaced over time and supported by managers.

PRACTICE FOR THE END TERM EXAMINATION

Questions to rehearse

"Most training is wasted because it does not transfer." Critically evaluate and propose remedies. **20 marks**

A strong answer: uses Baldwin and Ford and Blume et al.; addresses the work environment; adds spacing; designs a supported program.

Evaluate the 70:20:10 framework and deliberate practice as guides to development. **20 marks**

A strong answer: reports McCall et al. and Clardy accurately; reports Macnamara et al.; reaches a balanced view.

What is the spacing effect? **10 marks**

A strong answer: defines it; cites Cepeda et al.; one workplace application.

CARRY THESE INTO THE EXAMINATION

Three things to remember

1. The work environment decides whether training transfers
2. 70:20:10 is a heuristic, not a finding
3. Deliberate practice explains little variance in professional work

SET READINGS · FROM THE LESSON PLAN

Read for this lecture

Eby, L. T., Allen, T. D., Evans, S. C., Ng, T., & DuBois, D. L. (2008). Does mentoring matter? A multidisciplinary meta analysis comparing mentored and non mentored individuals. *Journal of Vocational Behavior, 72*(2), 254–267.

Jennings, C. (2013). *70:20:10 framework explained* [Practitioner monograph]. (Listed in the Lesson Plan; year not independently confirmed.)

Pfeffer, J. (1998). *The human equation: Building profits by putting people first*. Harvard Business School Press. Chapter 2.

HOW TO USE THESE

These are the Week 10 set readings. Jennings (2013) is the core reading for this lecture; it is a practitioner piece and its year could not be independently confirmed.

Sources for this lecture (1 of 3)

Works named on the slides of this lecture. They are background sources, not set readings.

Baldwin, T. T., & Ford, J. K. (1988). Transfer of training: A review and directions for future research. *Personnel Psychology, 41*(1), 63–105. https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1744-6570.1988.tb00632.x

Blume, B. D., Ford, J. K., Baldwin, T. T., & Huang, J. L. (2010). Transfer of training: A meta analytic review. *Journal of Management, 36*(4), 1065–1105. https://doi.org/10.1177/0149206309352880

Campion, M. A., Fink, A. A., Ruggeberg, B. J., Carr, L., Phillips, G. M., & Odman, R. B. (2011). Doing competencies well: Best practices in competency modeling. *Personnel Psychology, 64*(1), 225–262. https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1744-6570.2010.01207.x

Sources for this lecture (2 of 3)

Cepeda, N. J., Pashler, H., Vul, E., Wixted, J. T., & Rohrer, D. (2006). Distributed practice in verbal recall tasks: A review and quantitative synthesis. *Psychological Bulletin, 132*(3), 354–380. https://doi.org/10.1037/0033-2909.132.3.354

Clardy, A. (2018). 70:20:10 and the dominance of informal learning: A fact in search of evidence. *Human Resource Development Review, 17*(2), 153–178. https://doi.org/10.1177/1534484318759399

Ericsson, K. A., Krampe, R. T., & Tesch-Römer, C. (1993). The role of deliberate practice in the acquisition of expert performance. *Psychological Review, 100*(3), 363–406. https://doi.org/10.1037/0033-295x.100.3.363

Sources for this lecture (3 of 3)

Macnamara, B. N., Hambrick, D. Z., & Oswald, F. L. (2014). Deliberate practice and performance in music, games, sports, education, and professions: A meta analysis. *Psychological Science, 25*(8), 1608–1618. https://doi.org/10.1177/0956797614535810

McCall, M. W., Lombardo, M. M., & Morrison, A. M. (1988). *The lessons of experience: How successful executives develop on the job*. Lexington Books.